27 Oct 2026 07:03:44 ET | 16 pages

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

Likely 3Q2E Miss; Interaction With Mgmt. Confirms LT Growth Intact

CITI'S TAKE

We expect PharmaResearch (PR) to under-deliver 3Q26E OP vs. consensus, dragged by unfavorable sales mix, FX headwinds and loss-making subsidiary. Hence, we lower our margin outlook and cut TP to W450k. However, we continue to remain +ve on PR as we believe mgmt's strategies for global / pipeline expansion are likely to add new growth drivers.

Likely 3Q26E miss — We expect PR to record 3Q26E sales of W172bn (+27% YoY) and OP of W62bn (flat YoY, 36% OP margin), wherein we estimate OP to likely come 12% below current consensus. Reasons for the drag are primarily: 1) worse-than-expected sales mix (cosmetics mix 34% vs. 26% in 3Q25); 2) FX headwinds, and 3) headwinds from the loss-making CG USA acquisition (W1bn OP drag, CitiE). In terms of top line, we expect medical device to record W90bn and cosmetics W59bn, whereby cosmetics is likely to clock better-than-expected growth from Silicon2 /US wholesale shipment.

Interaction with the CEO — Mgmt is targeting 3-year topline CAGR of +25% underpinned by two major strategies: 1) global expansion, and 2) pipeline expansion. **For Global expansion**, mgmt. prioritizes securing fundamental leadership in existing markets, hence will establish total of 5 local subsidiaries (2 more to establish in EU and Japan). New major market expected for Rejuran approval will be Brazil (likely 1Q27E), along with step-up of EU sales. **For Pipeline expansion**, PR is set to launch its RF device by early 27E, finalize GMP approval of its toxin no.2 plant by mid-FY27E and launch renewal of Rejuran HB Plus targeted for treatment combination with its MNRF device.

Our positive view on the stock — We attribute recent valuation de-rating to higher domestic competition and slower top-line growth in medical device. We accordingly revise down our FY26E-FY28E NP estimates by 7-9% to reflect margin slowdown from unfavorable sales mix; hence, we lower our TP to W450k. However, we continue to reiterate Buy on PR as we believe new growth drivers are likely to offset the slowing top-line growth and margin: 1) medical device sales could rebound from FY27E along with cross selling / upselling from RF device (EBD) combination treatment, and 2) fundamental GP margin improvement for cosmetics given the efficiency increase in production via acquisition of CG USA.

Buy

Price (27 Oct 26 15:45)	W231,500
Target price	W450,000↓
from W500,000	
Expected share price return	94.4%
Expected dividend yield	1.7%
Expected total return	96.1%
Market Cap	W2,405,204M
	US$1,814M

Price Performance
(RIC: 214450.KQ, BB: 214450 KS)



Heejin Lim[AC]

Earnings Summary

Year to 31 Dec	Net Profit (WB)	Diluted EPS (W)	EPS growth (%)	P/E (x)	P/B (x)	ROE (%)	Yield (%)
2024A	92	8,838	17.9	26.2	4.5	18.9	0.5
2025A	165	15,801	78.8	14.7	3.5	26.9	1.6
2026E	210	18,192	15.1	12.7	2.8	27.1	1.7
2027E	241	20,850	14.6	11.1	2.3	24.9	2.0
2028E	295	25,534	22.5	9.1	1.8	24.7	2.5

Source: Powered by dataCentral

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

Prepared for Jay Lee

214450.KQ: Fiscal year end 31-Dec

Price: W231,500; TP: W450,000; Market Cap: W2,405,204m; Recomm: Buy

Profit & Loss (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	350	536	682	820	973
Cost of sales	-99	-125	-163	-200	-237
Gross profit	251	411	518	620	735
Gross Margin (%)	71.8	76.7	76.0	75.6	75.6
EBITDA (Adj)	**135**	**230**	**267**	**331**	**390**
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	38.6	42.9	39.2	40.3	40.1
Depreciation	-9	-10	-9	-10	-11
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0
EBIT (Adj)	**126**	**214**	**251**	**311**	**379**
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	36.0	40.0	36.8	37.9	38.9
Net interest	-16	9	32	13	17
Associates	6	0	0	0	0
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	0	-7	0	0	0
Pre-tax profit	**116**	**217**	**282**	**323**	**396**
Tax	-27	-48	-68	-78	-95
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	3	-3	-4	-5	-6
Reported net profit	**92**	**165**	**210**	**241**	**295**
Net Margin (%)	26.3	30.8	30.9	29.4	30.4
Core NPAT	92	165	210	241	295

Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Reported EPS (W)	8,838	15,801	18,192	20,850	25,534
Core EPS (W)	8,838	15,801	18,192	20,850	25,534
DPS (W)	1,100	3,700	4,050	4,640	5,680
CFPS (W)	13,262	17,527	12,673	20,565	25,589
FCFPS (W)	9,765	14,683	10,611	17,728	22,226
BVPS (W)	51,323	66,346	83,259	102,858	127,179
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	10.4	10.5	10.4	10.4	10.4
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	10.4	10.5	11.6	11.6	11.6

Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue (%)	34.1	53.2	27.1	20.4	18.5
EBIT (Adj) (%)	36.6	70.1	16.8	24.0	21.9
Core NPAT (%)	20.2	79.4	27.4	14.6	22.5
Core EPS (%)	17.9	78.8	15.1	14.6	22.5

Balance Sheet (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Cash & cash equiv.	452	620	758	912	1,109
Accounts receivables	43	52	60	73	87
Inventory	57	83	107	131	155
Net fixed & other tangibles	200	235	247	265	287
Goodwill & intangibles	33	31	33	37	43
Financial & other assets	70	22	22	22	22
Total assets	**856**	**1,044**	**1,229**	**1,441**	**1,703**
Accounts payable	11	11	15	18	22
Short-term debt	9	8	8	8	8
Long-term debt	1	0	0	0	0
Provisions & other liab	265	300	302	302	303
Total liabilities	**286**	**320**	**325**	**329**	**333**
Shareholders' equity	539	689	865	1,069	1,321
Minority interests	30	35	39	43	49
Total equity	**569**	**724**	**904**	**1,112**	**1,370**
Net debt (Adj)	**-442**	**-612**	**-750**	**-904**	**-1,101**
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	-77.6	-84.5	-83.0	-81.3	-80.3

Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
PE (x)	26.2	14.7	12.7	11.1	9.1
PB (x)	4.5	3.5	2.8	2.3	1.8
EV/EBITDA (x)	15.3	8.1	6.5	4.9	3.7
FCF yield (%)	4.2	6.3	4.6	7.7	9.6
Dividend yield (%)	0.5	1.6	1.7	2.0	2.5
Payout ratio (%)	12	23	22	22	22
ROE (%)	18.9	26.9	27.1	24.9	24.7

Cashflow (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBITDA	135	224	259	321	390
Working capital	0	-25	-28	-32	-33
Other	3	-17	-85	-51	-60
Operating cashflow	**138**	**183**	**147**	**238**	**296**
Capex	-36	-30	-24	-33	-39
Net acq/disposals	-170	-113	-7	-9	-12
Other	-20	-13	0	0	0
Investing cashflow	**-226**	**-156**	**-31**	**-42**	**-51**
Dividends paid	-10	-12	-39	-42	-48
Financing cashflow	**183**	**-15**	**-39**	**-42**	**-48**
Net change in cash	**96**	**10**	**77**	**154**	**197**
Free cashflow to s/holders	**102**	**153**	**123**	**205**	**257**

For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

Prepared for Jay Lee

Figure 1. PR: 3Q26E Results Preview

(Wbn)	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	YoY	QoQ	3Q26E Cons	Diff
Revenue	**135**	**143**	**146**	**179**	**172**	**27%**	**-4%**	**177**	**-3%**
YoY	52%	39%	25%	27%	27%				
1) By segment									
Medical device (Skinbooster)	77	83	80	97	90	18%	-7%		
Cosmetics	35	38	42	60	59	67%	-2%		
Pharmaceuticals	22	23	21	18	21	-6%	12%		
Others	2	(1)	3	3	3	80%	-21%		
2) By geography									
Domestic	85	85	88	95	92	8%	-3%		
Exports	50	58	58	83	80	60%	-4%		
Asia	33	37	34	45	46	42%	3%		
> China	18	18	-	-	-				
> Asia ex-China	15	19	-	-	-				
EU/Oceania	7	12	9	20	16	125%	-19%		
America	10	9	13	17	20	110%	16%		
Others	1	1	2	2	3	173%	59%		
Operating profit	**62**	**52**	**57**	**66**	**62**	**0%**	**-7%**	**71**	**-12%**
OPM	46%	36%	39%	37%	36%			40%	
YoY	77%	54%	28%	19%	0%				
RP	**65**	**50**	**68**	**74**	**65**	**0%**	**-12%**	**71**	**-9%**
Ex-minority NP	**49**	**33**	**48**	**57**	**48**	**-1%**	**-15%**	**57**	**-15%**

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, Bloomberg

Our take from the 2026 Global Symposium

PR has hosted 2026 Global Symposium, where 800 Key Opinion Leaders (KOL) participated compared to 500 KOL last year. The Symposium has become more systematic with bigger scale compared to last year, in our view, with key differences in providing lectures focused on treatment combinations ("RejuMix" – mix of PN, HA and botulinum toxin), wider indications (from facial rejuvenations to scars / ligaments / hair loss / post-chemotherapy skin regeneration, etc.) as well as delivering strong brand equity to KOLs (via dedicated factory tours and Chum salmon fishing experience). We believe annual symposiums help with education of PN and help strengthen PR's brand equity in the global context given the initial growth stage of the skin-booster industry.

PR also demonstrated its EBD device – "RE:INEX" – with scheduled approval by end-FY26E and commercial launch in early FY27E. Rejuran skin booster can be inserted within the device tip for the treatment combination (Rejuran skin booster infused within the skin dermis post the insertion of the microneedling RF). Mgmt

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believes introduction of EBD device could help reduce pain, as well as potential upselling of Rejuran to higher doses (up to 3cc vs. current 1-2cc).

Figure 2. PR: Global Symposium schedule (Day 1)



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Figure 3. PR: Global Symposium schedule (Day 2)



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Figure 4. PR: Quick peek at the Global Symposium



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Figure 5. PR: Quick peek at the Global Symposium



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Figure 6. PR: Earnings Revision

(W bn, %)	New			Old			%		
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	682	820	973	710	859	1,017	-4%	-4%	-4%
OP	251	311	379	278	343	412	-10%	-9%	-8%
RP	282	323	396	302	356	430	-7%	-9%	-8%
NP	210	241	295	225	266	321	-7%	-9%	-8%
OPM	36.8%	37.9%	38.9%	39.2%	40.0%	40.5%	-2.4%pt	-2.1%pt	-1.6%pt
RPM	41.4%	39.4%	40.7%	42.5%	41.5%	42.3%	-1.2%pt	-2.1%pt	-1.6%pt
NPM	30.9%	29.4%	30.4%	31.7%	30.9%	31.6%	-0.9%pt	-1.5%pt	-1.2%pt

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Removing Upside 90-Day Short-Term View on PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

Direction:	**Upside**
Date Added:	07 Aug 2026
Category:	Earnings

We close our current view as we see downside risks in OP miss in upcoming 3Q26E.

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Bull/Bear: PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

W 570,000	W 450,000	W 200,000
▲146% Upside	▲94% Upside	▼14% Downside



Spread 160pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 27 Oct 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Stronger-than-expected sales growth in medical device
- Higher-than-expected demand for cosmetics
- Better cost control management leading to higher margin profile

BASE Assumptions

- Medical device sales growth of +15% YoY in FY26E
- Cosmetics sales growth of +71% YoY in FY26E
- OP margin of 37% in FY26E

BEAR Assumptions

- Weaker-than-expected sales growth in medical device
- Lower-than-expected demand for cosmetics
- Less effective cost control management leading to lower margin profile

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PharmaResearch

Company description

PharmaResearch, founded in 2001, is a leading South Korean medical aesthetics/pharmaceutical company specializing in regenerative materials based on polynucleotide (PN)/polydeoxyribonucleotide (PDRN) ingredients. Its major products include facial injectable medical device Rejuran and arthritis joint cavity injection product Conjuran, followed by derivative value-added cosmetic products under the same Rejuran brand.

Investment strategy

We have a Buy rating on PharmaResearch, a leading company in the global medical aesthetics sector, underpinned by its regenerative PN/PDRN skin booster. Our investment thesis assumes: 1) solid topline growth potential in the domestic market from inbound tourism; 2) increasing penetration in EU/US markets backed by rising brand recognition; and 3) portfolio expansion into toxin, new collagen booster, and EBD providing additional catalysts.

Valuation

Our target price of W450k is based on a P/E methodology. We believe PR is set for strong growth momentum underpinned by: 1) full reflection of the EU market expansion; 2) increase in cosmetic penetration in the US; and 3) sustained growth across existing countries. We believe our target 2026E P/E multiple of 24x is justified, given 1) brand originality, which many local peers seem to lack, supporting competitiveness and longer product lifecycle; 2) stronger growth potential relative to top-tier peer's injectable aesthetics sales outlook; and 3) earnings upside risk from skinbooster TAM opportunities. Our target multiple is set at a 20% premium to PR's broader peer group given the above reasons.

Risks

Key downside risks that could impede the shares from reaching our target price include: 1) change in trend (or increase in competition) within skin boosters; 2) brand reputation risk in case of medical incidents; 3) rise of generics / competition post-Rejuran's patent expiry after 2030E; and 4) prolonged weak growth in overseas markets.

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Appendix A-1

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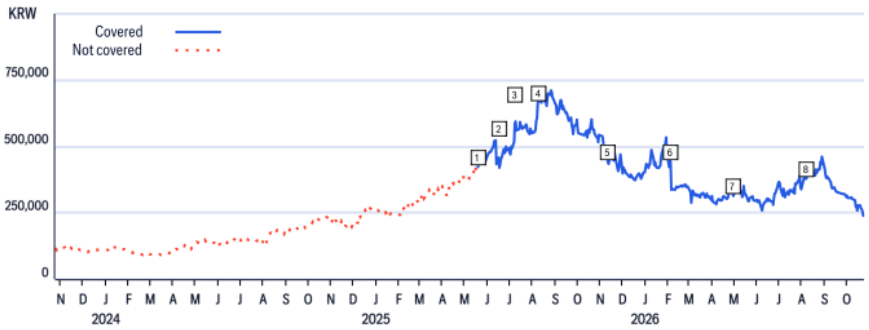
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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)
Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Heejin Lim



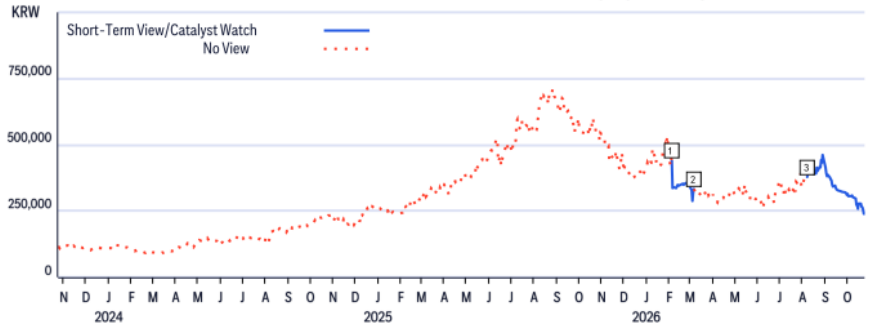
	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	19-May-25 04:55:14	*1H	*560,000.00	422,500.00
2	16-Jun-25 02:31:23	1H	*540,000.00	458,000.00
3	08-Jul-25 10:31:21	*1	*710,000.00	588,000.00
4	10-Aug-25 17:24:44	1	*800,000.00	664,000.00
5	11-Nov-25 11:50:03	1	*650,000.00	440,000.00
6	04-Feb-26 11:41:01	1	*570,000.00	439,500.00
7	30-Apr-26 13:47:42	1	*480,000.00	313,500.00
8	07-Aug-26 11:15:44	1	*500,000.00	378,500.00

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)
Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Heejin Lim



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	04-Feb-26 06:41:01	Add STV	Downside	30 Days	439,500.00
2	06-Mar-26 12:23:25	Remove STV	Downside	30 Days	333,000.00
3	07-Aug-26 07:15:44	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	378,500.00

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
Data current as of 01 Oct 2026	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**
Citi Research Global Fundamental Coverage (Neutral=Hold)	61%	32%	7%	36%	48%	16%
% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	39%	43%	30%	42%	38%	36%

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